

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Theatre, Puppetry and Performance Traditions - ASCII Master Flowchart

Text-native topic atlas | Same conceptual spine as quick-glance and graphical master

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Theatre, Puppetry and Performance Traditions - ASCII Master Flowchart

Text-native revision atlas aligned to the repaired learning session and workbook.

Central spine

THEATRE, PUPPETRY AND PERFORMANCE TRADITIONS

Natya Shastra grammar

- > Sanskrit stage vocabulary and convention
- > Kutiyattam as living continuity
- > Folk theatre as regional public
- > Colonial proscenium and modern institutions
- > Puppetry by mechanism
- > Ritual / martial / secular ecology
- > Safeguarding and answer route

CENTRAL RULE:

identify the form by mechanism, region or performance ecology,
then add the evidentiary qualification.

Natya Shastra frame

NATYA SHASTRA

Bharata -> Natya Veda -> text + enactment + music + rasa

- |
- +-- Lokadharmi = realistic depiction of life
- +-- Natyadharmi = stylised symbolic narration

WRITE:

theatre is composite performance, not literature alone.

DO NOT WRITE:

one falsely exact date or unchanged continuity across all later forms.

Classical vocabulary

TEN RUPAKAS

Nataka | Prakarana | Bhana | Prahasana | Dima

Vyayoga | Samavakara | Vithi | Ihamriga | Utsrishtikanka

STAGE ROLES

Sutradhar -> threshold / prayer / announcement

Nayaka -> hero

Nayika -> heroine

Vidusaka -> comic-satirical companion, Prakrit speech

EXAM TRAP:

do not mix genre terms with character or puppet vocabulary.

Convention, archaeology and decline

SANSKRIT THEATRE
four-to-seven acts
ordered opening -> progression -> pause -> conclusion
rare tragedy / order-restoring closure
Bharata stage prescription: about 400 persons, two levels, curtains

QUALIFICATION
prescription != archaeology
Sitabenga / Jogimara linked to performance by some scholars,
but 'world's oldest amphitheatre' is disputed.

DECLINE
plays -> poems and songs
difficult Sanskrit / wider Pali-Prakrit use
changed patronage

Kutiyattam continuity

KUTIYATTAM / KOODIYATTAM
Kerala
oldest continuing theatre lineage in the source-owned bank
Sanskrit + Prakrit + Malayalam
Mizhavu + Edakka
Nirvahana before story expansion

UNESCO OFFICIAL PAGE
one of India's oldest living theatrical traditions
synthesis of Sanskrit classicism and local Kerala practice
inscribed in 2008 on the Representative List

Folk theatre arc

FOLK THEATRE
local lifestyle + custom + belief
|
v
devotional origins (15th-16th century in many forms)
|
v
romance / local heroes
|
v
post-Independence social communication

DO NOT WRITE:
all forms are timelessly unchanged or mapped by fixed ancient state borders.

Regional theatres I

YAKSHAGANA -> Karnataka / parts of Kerala, Vijayanagara memory,
Vaishnava influence, dance-drama energy
JATRA -> eastern India, open-air, Chaitanya route,
later secular/patriotic themes
NAUTANKI -> north India, offshoot of Swang,
lyrical dialogue + Nagada
TAMASHA -> Maharashtra, humour + erotic charge + Lavani
BHAVAI -> Gujarat, dance-rich small plays, pots/pitchers,
Nayaka as Sutradhar

Regional theatres II

ANKIA NAAT / BHAONA -> Assam, Sankardeva field, Sutradhar,
Gayan-Bayan, Brajavali, masks
THERUKOOTTHU -> Tamil street theatre, epic themes,
song + drama + stage tricks
SWANG -> Rajasthan-Haryana-Malwa musical drama
MAACH -> Malwa, Rangat Dohas
BHAND PATHER -> Jammu and Kashmir, secular satire
DASHAVATAR -> Konkan, Vishnu's ten incarnations,
poorva-ranga + uttara-ranga

Modern theatre route

1775 Calcutta Theatre / New Playhouse
1876 Dramatic Performances Act
1850s-1920s Parsi theatre
1943 IPTA
1944 Prithvi Theatre
1952 Sangeet Natak Akademi
1969 Kalakshetra Manipur
1975 NSD independence
1976 Chorus Repertory Theatre

FIGURES

Tagore | Girish Chandra Ghosh | Binodini Dasi | Badal Sircar
K.V. Subbanna / NINASAM | Habib Tanvir | Girish Karnad

Puppetry mechanisms

STRING -> Kathputli / Kundhei / Gombeyatta
SHADOW -> Tolpava Kuthu / Ravana Chhaya / Tholu Bommalata /
Togalu Gombeyatta
ROD -> Yampuri / Putul Nach / Kathi Kundhei
GLOVE -> Pavakoothu
HYBRID -> Bommalattam (rod + string)

FIRST QUESTION:

how is the figure controlled?

Puppet ecology

STRING = articulated body
SHADOW = projected silhouette
ROD = larger standing manipulation
GLOVE = intimate hand control

PERFORMANCE ECOLOGY

narrator / Sutradhar
screen or curtain
music and rhythm support
village portability / travelling stage

ARCHIVE VALUE

Mahabharata + Silappadikaram + Bhagavad Gita metaphor

Safeguarding and final answer route

TWO DECLINE TYPES

Sanskrit theatre = historical contraction with named causes
Puppetry = ongoing audience/funding vulnerability

THEREFORE

text/documentation alone cannot safeguard a living performance.
Living forms need performers, pedagogy, repertory and audience.

BOUNDARIES

Topic 08 -> music systems

Topic 09 -> dance grammar

Topic 11 -> literary history

Topic 14 -> full UNESCO / SNA / NSD ledger